STRATEGY AND DECISION MEMO · 5 NOVEMBER 2026

UMMAH ONE

From an app to the digital infrastructure of the Muslim world

How to earn trust, grow through mosques and campuses, and build a credible path toward 200 million (20 crore) people

PREPARED FOR	Tanveer bhai and the Ummah One leadership team
FRAMEWORK	Meta Model (6 steps): clarify, expert panel, stress test, big picture, decision memo, expert confirmation
METHOD	BMAD Method v6, Analyst agent (Mary): market research, competitive teardown, Working Backwards PRFAQ, advanced elicitation (red team, pre-mortem, assumption audit)
EVIDENCE	Facts are cited to sources checked on 5 Nov 2026 (Appendix B). Analyst judgments and assumptions are labelled. Unknowns are stated, not guessed.

PROPOSED — requires confirmation by qualified human subject-matter experts.

Expert views in this memo are structured AI analyses, not human sign-off. Market, financial, legal, operational, Shariah and product assumptions must be confirmed before any commitment of capital.

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8. Expert confirmation	Challenger and feasibility reviews, disagreements, evidence that resolves them
9. Working Backwards PRFAQ (BMAD)	Future press release, hardest FAQs, the verdict
Appendix A and B	Assumptions register; sources

Executive summary

Ummah One can become the trusted digital infrastructure of the Muslim world, but not by launching an app with many features. The research and the expert panel point to one strategy: turn the networks the Ummah already has (its mosques, campuses and business associations) into software, earn trust before scale, and grow through communities rather than advertising.

Three moves carry the strategy

1. **Grow through mosques, not ads.** A congregation is the Ummah's smallest self-sustaining network: dense, local, trusted, and it meets every Friday. Give each mosque free tools (a verified page, iqamah and Jumu'ah times, events, announcements) and let committees bring their congregations. Indonesia's government registry alone lists about 300,000 mosques and 376,000 prayer halls (SIMAS, March 2024). At 200 million users, the maths only works through this channel. Start with **lighthouse mosques in high-income neighbourhoods** (for example DHA Karachi, Bangsar in Kuala Lumpur, Pondok Indah in Jakarta, KAFD in Riyadh, Dubai Marina), each twinned with mosques in lower-income areas.
2. **Lead with Education, anchor with the Directory, earn money from B2B halal trade.** Students are the most acute, highest-intent users. Mosque pages give weekly frequency. Halal businesses and universities pay. The Marketplace starts as B2B sourcing (verified suppliers plus requests for quotation), not consumer e-commerce competing with Shopee, Tokopedia, Noon or Daraz.
3. **Make trust the moat.** Verified institutions, halal certificates checked against the issuing authority, a neutral non-sectarian governance, and a public pledge never to sell personal or location data. In 2020, reporting that location data linked to Muslim Pro users reached a US military contractor through a data broker became global news within days. That is how fast trust can be lost in this category.

Recommendation

Item	Proposed answer
Decision	**GO, conditional (pivot the entry, keep the vision).** Run a 90-day validation phase that ends with a Ramadan 2027 pilot in 10–15 lighthouse mosques in one city, plus twinned mosques. Commit to the full MVP only if the gate metrics pass by end of March 2027.
Confidence	**Medium** for reaching 100,000 then 1 million users if the mosque and campus channels validate. **Low** for 200 million within 10 years. That figure would make Ummah One larger than any Muslim-focused platform on record (Muslim Pro reported 98M+ downloads by 2020, and downloads are not users). Keep 200M as the ambition; run the company on retention gates.
Why now	Ramadan is expected to begin around 8 February 2027 (subject to moon sighting): the highest-engagement season of the year arrives in about 13 weeks and is the cheapest possible test of the mosque channel.
What must be proven	That mosques adopt a free tool and bring members; that members come back weekly; that businesses and universities pay; that a neutral governance model holds.

Key numbers behind the plan

Fact	Value	Source
Muslims worldwide (2020)	about 2.0 billion, 25.6% of the world; +347 million since 2010	Pew Research Center, June 2025
Largest Muslim population	Indonesia, about 240 million (≈12% of all Muslims)	Pew Research Center, June 2025
Muslim consumer spending	US$2.43 trillion (2023), projected US$3.36 trillion by 2028	DinarStandard SGIE 2024/25
Muslim-friendly travel	US$216.9 billion (2023) to US$384.1 billion (2028), fastest-growing sector	DinarStandard SGIE 2024/25
Indonesia digital reach	230 million internet users (80.5%), 180 million social media identities (Oct 2025)	DataReportal Digital 2026
Pakistan digital reach	79.9 million social media identities, 31.2% of population (Oct 2025)	DataReportal Digital 2026
200M target in context	about 10% of the world's Muslims	Arithmetic on Pew figure

1. How this memo was built

This memo answers the Meta Model prompt step by step, using the **BMAD Method** (Breakthrough Method for Agile AI-Driven Development, v6, from the official repository bmad-code-org/BMAD-METHOD). Its Analyst agent, **Mary**, is defined as channelling Michael Porter's strategic rigour and Barbara Minto's Pyramid Principle, with three principles: every finding grounded in verifiable evidence, requirements stated with precision, every stakeholder voice represented. The memo therefore puts the answer first and the support after it.

BMAD Analyst capability (menu code)	How it was applied here
Market research (MR)	Reachable market, not headline size; customer segments; pains; competitors including substitutes and "do nothing"; go-to-market and pricing dynamics (Section 3, 6).
Competitive teardown (CR)	Who competes for each job Ummah One wants to do, and where they are weak (Section 3).
User voice (UV)	Jobs to be done per customer group (Section 2). No primary interviews exist yet; that gap is flagged.
Working Backwards PRFAQ (WB)	Imagined launch press release, hardest customer and internal questions, and a verdict: forged in steel, needs more heat, cracks in the foundation (Section 9).
Advanced elicitation	Red team, pre-mortem, assumption audit, steelmanning, first-principles and inversion passes on the draft (Sections 5 and 8).
Product brief (CB)	Problem, solution, differentiation, users, success criteria, scope and vision (Section 6).

Evidence standard and limits

Numbers are cited to sources opened during this research pass (Appendix B). Where sources disagree, the memo says so. Analyst judgments are labelled as such. Legal references come from general knowledge and must be confirmed by counsel.

The eight experts and two reviewers are structured AI analyses, each written with full context. They are not human experts. BMAD was used from its repository; its Node-based installer was not available on this machine, so its workflows were applied manually.

2. Clarify the problem

The problem in one sentence

Problem statement

Muslims and Muslim institutions across countries cannot easily find, verify and connect with each other's businesses, education and opportunities, because that information is scattered across WhatsApp groups, social media, generic platforms and word of mouth, with no trusted layer that confirms who is real and what is halal.

Who the customers are, and the job each is trying to do

Customer	Job to be done	Current alternatives	Pain (analyst judgment)
Students and parents	Find affordable, high-quality, Muslim-friendly study options and scholarships	University sites, education agents, course portals, Facebook groups, YouTube	High: big decision, fragmented information, scholarship scams
Halal SMEs and exporters	Be found by buyers abroad; prove halal status	Trade fairs, general B2B platforms, distributors, WhatsApp	High for exporters, medium for local shops
Families and individuals	Find trusted mosques, events, services and halal products nearby or while travelling	Google Maps, WhatsApp groups, devotional apps, word of mouth	Medium: partly served today
Mosques and Islamic organisations	Reach and organise their congregation; announce events; run classes and volunteers	WhatsApp groups, Facebook pages, notice boards, prayer-time screens	Medium to high: low digital capacity
Universities	Recruit international Muslim students; show a Muslim-friendly campus	Agents, fairs, ranking profiles, social ads	Medium
Employers	Hire across Muslim markets	LinkedIn, job boards, agencies	Medium

Analyst insight: the real competitor is the WhatsApp group

For most of these jobs, the alternative people use today is free, familiar and already on their phone: a WhatsApp group, a Facebook page, Google Maps. Ummah One will not win by replacing them. It wins by being the verified, searchable memory behind them, and by sharing into them.

Assumptions that must be validated

Every assumption below is untested. Appendix A turns each one into a test, an owner and a deadline.

- **A1** Muslims in five different countries want one cross-border platform rather than national apps.
- **A2** Mosque committees will adopt a free digital tool and actively promote it to their congregations.

- **A3** Students will use Ummah One for universities and scholarships instead of agents and existing portals.
- **A4** Halal businesses will pay for verification and for B2B leads.
- **A5** Universities will pay for visibility and recruitment, where this is lawful.
- **A6** A neutral, non-sectarian governance model is achievable and accepted across communities.
- **A7** Partnerships with religious authorities are possible in Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Malaysia within year one.
- **A8** Verification can be run at an acceptable cost per listing, with halal certificates checkable at source.
- **A9** Community channels (mosques, campuses, referrals) deliver users far cheaper than paid ads.
- **A10** The team can run five languages at launch (Urdu, Bahasa Indonesia, Malay, Arabic, English).

3. The market: what is real and what is reachable

BMAD's market research pack starts from the *reachable* market, not the headline. The headline is large: about 2.0 billion Muslims (Pew, 2020) and US$2.43 trillion of Muslim consumer spending across food, pharmaceuticals, cosmetics, modest fashion, travel and media (SGIE 2024/25). A newer edition of the same report puts 2024 spending at about US$2.6 trillion. But spending is not platform revenue. Ummah One's revenue comes only from businesses, universities, employers and partners who pay to reach people, so the reachable market is the number of those institutions that can be verified and served.

Digital readiness differs sharply between the priority markets

- **Indonesia**: 230 million internet users (80.5% of the population) and 180 million social media identities, up 26% in a year (DataReportal, October 2025). The scale market.
- **Pakistan**: 79.9 million social media identities, 31.2% of the population (DataReportal, October 2025). Large population, but lower online share, so offline onboarding (mosques, campuses) matters more.
- **Malaysia, Saudi Arabia, UAE**: smaller populations, high digital readiness, and the strongest universities, halal-certification systems and buyer demand. They are the destination end of the network.

Competitive landscape by job

Job	Who competes today	Where they are weak (analyst judgment)	Ummah One angle
Daily devotion (prayer times, Quran)	Muslim Pro (98M+ downloads reported by 2020); MAWAQIT (says 3M+ users; mosque-connected prayer times)	Crowded; the daily habit is already owned	Do not compete. Ummah One is not a prayer app. Link to mosque-specific iqamah times instead, or partner
Local discovery	Google Maps, local directories	No verification of halal status or institutional identity	Verified institutions and certificates
Commerce	Shopee, Tokopedia, Lazada, Noon, Daraz (consumer); general B2B platforms	Halal verification is shallow; no community trust layer	B2B halal sourcing with certificates checked at source
Education	University sites, agents, course portals, QS and THE rankings	Not aware of Muslim life: prayer space, halal food, female housing, OIC scholarships	Muslim-life-aware study atlas plus STEM and Medical Cities Index
Community	WhatsApp groups, Facebook pages	Unsearchable, unverified, no memory	Become the verified memory behind the groups, and share into them

Analyst insight: the gap is the verified graph, not another feature

No player in this scan owns a cross-border, verified map of Muslim institutions (mosques, universities, certified businesses) and the opportunities they publish. That graph is slow to build and hard to copy, which is what makes it a moat. Features are easy to copy; verified relationships with 100,000 mosques are not.

4. The independent expert panel

Each expert received the full brief (the Ummah One plan, the 18-city education list, the travel destinations, the mosque requirement and the research facts above) and answered independently, without seeing the others' views.

Customer Expert — demand, pain, willingness to pay, adoption barriers

Key findings	Six customer groups with different jobs. Acute pain sits with students (high-stakes, scam-prone decisions) and exporting halal SMEs. Individuals' directory need is real but infrequent and partly served by Google Maps and WhatsApp. Willingness to pay sits with businesses, universities and employers, not individuals.
Evidence or reasoning	No primary interviews exist yet. Reasoning from jobs to be done: how often a job recurs and how much is at stake predict adoption. Individuals adopt what their mosque, campus or employer already uses.
Assumptions	Users prefer one cross-border platform to national apps; elders will adopt with in-person help after prayers.
Top risks	"Nice to have" for individuals; app fatigue; low-end phones and data costs; language; distrust after past data controversies.
SME questions	What do mosque committees struggle with digitally? Where do students in Pakistan and Indonesia lose the most time or money finding scholarships? Do halal SMEs pay today to be found by foreign buyers, and how much?

Market Expert — size, trends, competitors, differentiation, timing

Key findings	The base is large and growing: about 2.0 billion Muslims; US$2.43 trillion consumer spending in 2023; Muslim-friendly travel the fastest-growing sector (12.1% CAGR to 2028). Digital reach is high in Indonesia, lower in Pakistan. Timing favours a trust-first entrant: privacy has been a public issue in this category since 2020.
Evidence or reasoning	Pew Research Center 2025; DinarStandard SGIE 2024/25; DataReportal Digital 2026; press coverage of the 2020 Muslim Pro data controversy.
Assumptions	Spending power turns into platform revenue only through businesses and universities. Headline market size is not reachable revenue.
Top risks	Mistaking total spending for reachable revenue; Google, regional e-commerce or super-apps adding halal filters; devotional apps already own the daily habit.
SME questions	Which halal export categories into the Gulf are growing fastest? Would OIC-level bodies (halal accreditation, education ministries) endorse a private platform?

Product Expert — value proposition, MVP scope, product risks, user experience

Key findings	Value proposition: find, verify, connect. MVP: a mosque-anchored Directory plus the Education Network. B2B sourcing beta after 100,000 users. Out of the MVP: payments, zakat collection, social feed and chat, consumer e-commerce, the other seven divisions. UX: Android-first, works on low bandwidth, five languages, WhatsApp sharing, large-type mode for elders.
Evidence or reasoning	Frequency analysis: of the three core features, only a mosque layer has a natural weekly rhythm (Jumu'ah). Directory searches, university choices and B2B sourcing are occasional.
Assumptions	Institutions keep pages current if it saves them effort, for example one update that posts to the page and to their WhatsApp group.
Top risks	Cold start (an empty directory); stale data; scope creep toward a "super app" before the core works.

SME questions	What is the minimum mosque page a committee will maintain every week? Which scholarship details do students need before they trust a listing?

Operations Expert — delivery model, staffing, scalability, execution risks

Key findings	The bottleneck is operations, not code: verification, partnerships, content, moderation in five languages, and managing ambassadors. Delivery model: country teams on one shared platform; AI-assisted verification with human review.
Evidence or reasoning	Every verified listing needs a document check; every mosque needs a human relationship; every scholarship needs checking against scams.
Assumptions	Verification cost per listing can be kept low; halal registries can be queried.
Top risks	Verification backlog; uneven ambassador quality; partner churn; moderation load across languages and time zones.
SME questions	Do JAKIM, BPJPH and the Pakistan Halal Authority offer public certificate lookups or APIs? How long do partnerships with religious ministries take in Saudi Arabia and the UAE?

Finance Expert — revenue model, unit economics, pricing, capital, break-even

Key findings	Individuals free for ever. Revenue from businesses (verification, premium profiles, B2B leads), universities, employers and travel affiliates; contextual sponsorship only. Unit economics are unknown today; Section 6.14 sets out what must be true. Capital should be released in phases against gates.
Evidence or reasoning	Arithmetic on hypothetical inputs (Section 6.14); the privacy pledge rules out the data-and-ads model many free apps rely on.
Assumptions	B2B revenue can fund the free consumer side; community channels cost less per user than paid ads.
Top risks	Monetising too late; pressure to sell ads that conflicts with the pledge; currency and payment friction across five markets.
SME questions	What will SMEs pay for verification in Pakistan and Indonesia versus the Gulf? Which university recruitment-fee models are lawful in each country?

Legal and Compliance Expert — licences, data privacy, liability, regulation, contracts

Key findings	Religious affiliation is sensitive personal data in many regimes. Relevant laws include Indonesia's Personal Data Protection Law (No. 27 of 2022), Malaysia's PDPA 2010, Saudi Arabia's PDPL and the UAE's Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021. The status of Pakistan's comprehensive data protection law must be confirmed. Halal status should be shown only as issued by authorities (Indonesia: Halal Product Assurance Law No. 33 of 2014). Zakat and charity collection is regulated, so it is excluded from the MVP. Paid influencer rules (UAE) and education-agent rules (Malaysia) need confirming. Trademark clearance for "Ummah One" is needed.
Evidence or reasoning	General legal knowledge; must be confirmed by counsel in each country.
Assumptions	While the Marketplace is request-for-quotation only, Ummah One operates as an information service and needs no e-commerce or payment licence.
Top risks	Data localisation requirements; defamation through reviews; liability for a fake certificate; approvals for religious content.
SME questions	Country counsel: data residency, religious-content approvals, influencer permits, education-agent rules, platform liability, trademark.

Growth Expert — acquisition, retention, partnerships, brand

Key findings	Channel order by expected cost and trust: mosques, then campuses and ambassadors, then institutions' own channels, then organic social and creators, then paid ads last. Loops: mosque to congregation; student to classmates; business to its suppliers and buyers. Seasonal spikes: Ramadan, Eid, academic intakes.

Evidence or reasoning	The brief's own principle (community-driven growth) plus how network products overcome the cold start: a useful single-player tool first, the network second.
Assumptions	At least half of sign-ups can come from community channels (a proposed target, not a benchmark).
Top risks	Ambassador spam; referral fraud; brand dilution; a political or sectarian post going viral.
SME questions	Scholars: which referral rewards are permissible? Lawyers: licensing rules for paid creators in each market.

Risk Expert — top risks, failure modes, dependencies, mitigations

Key findings	Top risks: low frequency leading to an empty network; a trust breach; religious or political controversy; regulatory blocks; running out of cash before monetisation; competitive response; dilution across too many markets and features; security incidents exposing data of Muslim minorities.
Evidence or reasoning	Pre-mortem and failure-mode analysis (Section 5); the 2020 data controversy as the reference case for trust risk.
Assumptions	Mitigations in Section 6.20 can be funded within Phase 1.
Top risks	Dependencies: religious authorities, halal registries, app stores, WhatsApp, cloud hosting and data-residency rules.
SME questions	Security specialist: threat model for a high-profile Muslim platform. Scholars: neutrality and moderation governance.

5. Stress test

Three strongest reasons Ummah One could fail

1. **Low frequency leads to an empty network.** Directory searches, university choices and sourcing are occasional jobs. Without weekly reasons to return, active use collapses and businesses stop paying.
2. **Trust failure.** One scandal (a data sale, a fake halal certificate, a scholarship scam, a sectarian row) can end a platform whose brand is the Ummah itself.
3. **Dilution.** Five countries, three features, six customer groups and five languages, attempted at once by a small team, means nothing is done excellently.

Three strongest reasons it could succeed

1. **The networks already exist.** Mosques, campuses and business associations are dense, trusted and organised. If the tool is genuinely useful, distribution costs almost nothing.
2. **A large, growing, under-served economy.** US$2.43 trillion of consumer spending and the fastest-growing travel segment, but no cross-border verified layer connecting it (analyst judgment).
3. **Trust is a winnable moat.** A privacy-first, verified, neutral platform is a credible differentiator in this category. The team's private-AI capability allows personalisation without selling data.

Pre-mortem: it is November 2028 and Ummah One has failed. What happened?

The failure story (imagined, to find weak points early)

We launched in five countries at once with all three features. A viral campaign brought 400,000 downloads, but 30-day retention was in single digits because nothing brought people back weekly. Mosque partnerships stalled in Saudi Arabia and the UAE because we approached individual imams instead of the authorities. A featured supplier's fake halal certificate went viral. We planned advertising as the main revenue, but our own privacy pledge limited targeting, and businesses had not been asked to pay early. A sectarian argument in the comments of one mosque page became national news. We ran out of money at month 20.

Every element of the strategy in Section 6 is designed to prevent one of these.

Red team: challenging the original brief

Element of the brief	Challenge	Revision
Start with three core features	All three are infrequent jobs, so none of them creates a weekly habit	Add a mosque layer to the Directory as the weekly anchor; lead with Education
Five priority markets	Launching in five at once dilutes a small team	Sequence: one city, then two corridors, then five markets
Halal Marketplace	Consumer e-commerce means a logistics and payments war with Shopee, Tokopedia and Noon	Start with B2B sourcing: verified suppliers plus requests for quotation
200M users by years 8–10	Would exceed any Muslim-focused platform on record	Keep as the ambition; manage the company on active users and retention gates
"One Ummah, One Marketplace"	Over-promises at launch; may read as political in some jurisdictions	Use only once the Marketplace exists; test the wording per country
Referral rewards	Chance-based prizes may raise maysir concerns; open to fraud	Fixed, earned rewards approved by the Shariah board; paid only on verified activity
Influencer campaigns	Paid influencer promotion is licensed in some markets (for example the UAE)	Use licensed creators with clear disclosure
"Muslim business" directory	Judging who is a "Muslim business" is contentious	Verify facts (registration, certificates, ownership claims), never piety

What is still unknown

The brief does not state: team size and location; available capital; legal entity; existing partnerships; trademark status; technology already built; device mix in target markets; cost per user by channel; willingness to pay; typical congregation sizes; ministry approval timelines. Each is listed as a question in Section 7.I.

6. The big picture strategy

6.1 Vision

Vision statement

Ummah One becomes the trusted digital infrastructure of the Muslim world: a verified network where every mosque, university and halal business has a living identity, and where any Muslim (a student in Lahore, a supplier in Surabaya, a family in Riyadh) can find, verify and connect with the opportunities of the global Muslim economy in their own language. It grows through the institutions the Ummah already trusts, it never sells its members' data, and it measures success not by downloads but by how many lives it connects every week.

6.2 Problem–solution fit

Problem	Solution	Proof needed
Information is scattered and unverified	Verified profiles for institutions, businesses and opportunities	Share of listings verified; user trust scores in interviews
Students cannot compare Muslim-friendly options	Education Network with Muslim-life data and a STEM and Medical Cities guide	Scholarship applications started via Ummah One
Halal suppliers cannot reach foreign buyers credibly	B2B profiles with certificates checked at source, plus requests for quotation	Requests answered; deals reported

Problem	Solution	Proof needed
Mosques lack simple digital tools	Free verified mosque page with times, events and announcements	Mosques updating weekly; members following their mosque
No reason to return	Weekly mosque digest, deadlines, local opportunities	Weekly active members; 30-day retention

6.3 Beachhead: win corridors, not countries

The five priority markets play different roles. Pakistan and Indonesia supply students, talent and halal SMEs. Malaysia, Saudi Arabia and the UAE offer universities, scholarships, buyers and jobs. Ummah One creates value by connecting the two ends, so the beachhead is a set of **corridors**.

Corridor (hypothesis)	What flows	Ummah One job	Hypothesis to test
Pakistan and Indonesia to Malaysia, Türkiye, Gulf	Students	Education Network	Students prefer a Muslim-life-aware study atlas to agents
Indonesia, Malaysia, Pakistan to the Gulf	Halal products	B2B sourcing	Gulf buyers will source from verified suppliers via requests for quotation
Pakistan and Indonesia to UAE and Saudi Arabia	Workers and professionals	Directory in the new city; verified employers	Expats want a trusted mosque and services directory, and safe jobs
Global to Malaysia, Türkiye, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Travellers and pilgrims	Discover the Muslim World content	Travel content brings in users cheaply

Market	Role in the network	Evidence	Entry partners
Pakistan	Students, talent, SMEs; likely team home market (assumption)	Large population; offline-first onboarding needed	Mosque committees, housing-society managements (DHA, Bahria), universities, chambers
Indonesia	Scale market	About 240M Muslims; 230M internet users; ~676K registered mosques and prayer halls	Indonesian Mosque Council (DMI), Nahdlatul Ulama, Muhammadiyah, pesantren networks
Malaysia	Education and halal hub	Universiti Malaya 58th in QS 2026 and 56th in QS 2027; #1 OIC destination in GMTI 2025	Universities, state Islamic religious councils, halal ecosystem
Saudi Arabia	Universities, scholarships, buyers, Hajj and Umrah	KFUPM 67th in QS 2026	Ministry-level partnerships, universities
UAE	Expat hub, buyers, capital	Top-ranked OIC destination in GMTI 2025	Islamic affairs authority (Awqaf), employers, free zones

Recommended first city: wherever the team already has relationships. If that is Pakistan, start in Karachi or Lahore, with Kuala Lumpur as the second city because it anchors education and halal certification.

6.4 Unique value proposition and positioning

> **Unique value proposition**
>
> The one place where Muslim institutions, businesses and opportunities are verified, and where your data is never for sale.

Positioning statement. For Muslims and Muslim institutions across Asia and the Gulf who need to find and trust opportunities beyond their own WhatsApp groups, Ummah One is the verified network of the Muslim economy, connecting mosques, universities and halal businesses. Unlike generic platforms and devotional apps, Ummah One verifies institutions and halal status at source, and grows through the mosques and campuses people already trust.

In the brief's words: not "just another Muslim application", but **the digital infrastructure connecting the global Muslim economy and community**.

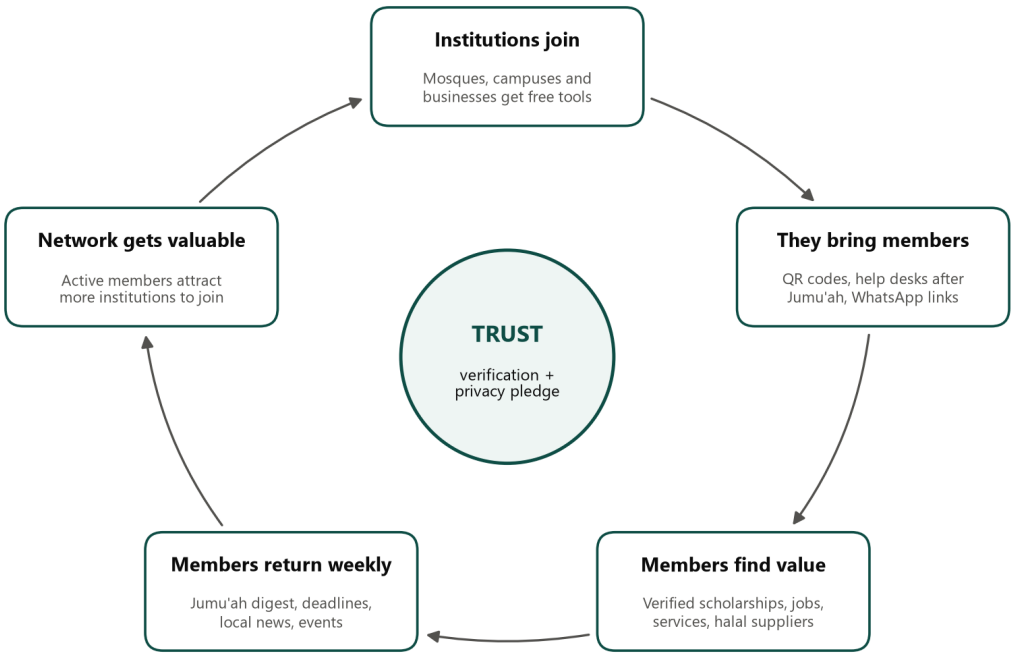
6.5 Core product: three features, sequenced

Feature	In the MVP	Later	Explicitly out
Global Muslim Directory	Verified mosque pages (iqamah and Jumu'ah times, events, announcements, facilities including women's areas); verified businesses and organisations; search in five languages	Reviews tied to verified interactions; local offers	Social feed, chat
Education Network	University profiles with Muslim-life information; scholarship feed with deadlines; STEM and Medical Cities guide	Application tracking, verified agents, alumni mentors	Tuition payments
Halal Marketplace	B2B beta after 100,000 users: supplier profiles with verified certificates, requests for quotation	Trade-finance and logistics partners	Consumer e-commerce, holding funds, zakat collection

6.6 The growth engine: a mosque-first network

Network products die from the cold-start problem: an empty network has no value, so nobody joins. Two well-known ideas from technology strategy solve it. First, start from an **atomic network**, the smallest group that is useful on its own (Andrew Chen, *The Cold Start Problem*). Second, **come for the tool, stay for the network** (Chris Dixon): give each participant something useful before the network exists. For the Ummah, the atomic network already exists and meets every Friday: the congregation. The tool is a free mosque page that saves the committee time.

The Ummah One flywheel: institutions bring members, members bring institutions



Trust sits at the centre: if verification or privacy fails, every step of the loop slows down.

6.7 The mosque playbook

Four principles of adab, agreed before any promotion

1. **The mosque is for worship.** The Prophet (peace be upon him) said that if you see someone buying or selling in the mosque, say: may Allah not make your trade profitable (Jami' at-Tirmidhi 1321). Ummah One is therefore introduced as a **community service**, never as advertising, and the Marketplace is never promoted inside the prayer hall.
2. **Work through the mosque's legitimate authority:** the committee, the waqf board or the ministry, depending on the country.
3. **Stay neutral** across madhahib and groups. No sectarian or political content.
4. **Ask scholars first** before any new mechanic (referral rewards, sponsorship, donations).

Nine steps from first visit to an active mosque

1. **Masjid Hub, free:** a verified mosque page with iqamah and Jumu'ah times, events, classes, announcements and facilities. Low-tech committees can update it from WhatsApp.
2. **Onboard the committee in about 20 minutes**, with an ambassador doing the setup alongside them.
3. **A unique QR code per mosque** on notice boards and entrances, so every sign-up is attributed to its mosque.
4. **A help desk after Jumu'ah** in the courtyard or community hall (never the prayer hall) where volunteers help elders and families sign up.
5. **Announcements by the committee**, not inserted into the khutbah unless the responsible authority approves.
6. **Seasonal moments:** Ramadan (taraweeh, iftar, i'tikaf and Laylat al-Qadr schedules), Eid prayer locations, Dhul Hijjah and Qurbani information, Hajj and Umrah.
7. **Opportunity Days** in mosque community halls: scholarships, jobs and verified halal businesses, with committee and scholar approval.
8. **Twinning:** every lighthouse mosque adopts three sister mosques (Section 6.8).
9. **Measure each mosque:** members onboarded, weekly active members, referrals, page updates.

How mosques are organised in each priority market

Country	How mosques are organised	Partnership route	Note
Indonesia	Mostly community-run. The ministry's SIMAS registry listed 299,692 mosques and 376,469 prayer halls (March 2024)	Indonesian Mosque Council (DMI), Nahdlatul Ulama, Muhammadiyah, Ministry of Religious Affairs	Bahasa-first; the largest scale
Pakistan	Largely committee-run; some under provincial Auqaf departments; housing-society mosques run by society administrations	Committees; DHA and Bahria Town administrations; madrasa boards	Neutrality policy essential
Malaysia	Under state Islamic religious councils, with JAKIM at federal level	State councils (for example MAIWP in the Federal Territories)	Formal approvals; strong digital readiness
Saudi Arabia	Ministry of Islamic Affairs, Dawah and Guidance oversees mosques	Ministry-level partnership	Do not approach imams individually
UAE	Federal Islamic affairs authority (Awqaf) oversees mosques and sermons	Authority-level partnership	Large expat congregations add corridor value

The mosque maths: why this channel matches the 200M ambition

Partner mosques	Members per mosque needed to reach 200M	Reading
100,000	2,000	Only very large congregations reach this

Partner mosques	Members per mosque needed to reach 200M	Reading
250,000	800	Plausible for city Jumu'ah mosques
500,000	400	Needs wave-2 markets as well as the first five
1,000,000	200	Requires most of the world's large mosque networks

Typical congregation size is not known and varies widely; the Ramadan pilot measures members per mosque directly. For scale: Indonesia's registry alone exceeds 670,000 mosques and prayer halls. No other channel (ads, influencers, app stores) reaches these numbers at a cost a young company can afford.

6.8 High-income areas and their mosques: lighthouse sites

Start where adoption and revenue are easiest, then cascade. Mosques in high-income neighbourhoods usually have professional committees, existing social media, and congregations of professionals, business owners and university-educated families: the early adopters, the paying businesses and the opinion leaders. In the Gulf, the same neighbourhoods hold large expatriate congregations, which links each lighthouse mosque back to Pakistan, Indonesia and beyond: the corridor effect.

City	High-income area	Lighthouse mosque(s)	Why it matters	Status
Karachi	DHA and Clifton	Masjid-e-Tooba (Gol Masjid), DHA Phase 2; built 1969; main hall about 5,000	Professionals and business owners; iconic single-dome landmark	Source checked
Lahore	DHA, Gulberg, Bahria Town	Grand Jamia Mosque, Bahria Town; inaugurated 2014; about 25,000 indoors	Professionally managed society mosque; huge Eid and Jumu'ah crowds	Source checked
Islamabad	Sectors F-6, F-7, E-7	Faisal Mosque (state-managed national mosque) and sector mosques	Civil servants, diplomats, universities	Well known; partner via authority
Kuala Lumpur	Bangsar	Masjid Saidina Abu Bakar As-Siddiq, Jalan Ara; won the 2023 Muhibbah Award for community work	Urban professionals; active community programmes	Source checked
Kuala Lumpur	Mont Kiara, Jalan Duta	Masjid Wilayah Persekutuan (Federal Territory Mosque)	Expatriate and professional families	To confirm
Putrajaya, Cyberjaya	Government and tech hubs	Putra Mosque; Masjid Raja Haji Fisabilillah	Civil servants, tech workers, universities	To confirm
Jakarta	Pondok Indah	Masjid Raya Pondok Indah (the "Blue Mosque"); about 4,000, up to 7,000 with plaza; large i'tikaf crowds	Affluent families; strong Ramadan programme	Source checked
Jakarta	Kebayoran Baru, Menteng	Masjid Agung Al-Azhar; Masjid Agung Sunda Kelapa	Established elite neighbourhoods; school networks	To confirm
Riyadh	King Abdullah Financial District	KAFD Grand Mosque, the district's Friday mosque (designed by Omrania)	Finance professionals and corporates	Source checked; ministry route
Riyadh	Al Olaya, Hittin, Al Malqa	Neighbourhood mosques (to be mapped)	Affluent residential districts	To map
Dubai	Dubai Marina	Al Rahim Mosque, the Marina's main mosque	Dense expat professional population: a corridor hub	Source checked
Dubai	Jumeirah, Al Safa	Jumeirah Mosque; Al Farooq Omar Bin Al Khattab Mosque	Affluent residents; cultural visitors	To confirm
Abu Dhabi	Saadiyat, Al Reem	Sheikh Zayed Grand Mosque (state landmark)	Brand and content partner, not an onboarding venue	Well known

"High-income" here means neighbourhoods commonly described as affluent. Confirm with local income or property data before final selection. Landmark state mosques are partners for content and brand through the authorities, not places to run sign-up desks.

How to choose lighthouse mosques

- Jumu'ah attendance and an active programme (classes, iftar, youth activities).
- A committee with digital capacity, and willingness to twin with three mosques in lower-income areas.
- Density of businesses, clinics and schools within about 3 km (future verified listings).
- Approvals in place from the responsible authority.

> **Guardrail: lighthouse, then cascade**
>
> An Ummah platform that serves only the wealthy fails its own name. Every lighthouse mosque twins with three sister mosques, the product stays light enough for low-end Android phones and expensive data, and success is reported for twin mosques separately so they are never an afterthought.

6.9 Ambassadors, referrals and campaigns

Ambassador tier	Who	Role	Recognition
Campus Ambassador	Students	Campus chapters, scholarship sessions, onboarding classmates	Certificate, internship pipeline, small stipend
Masjid Volunteer	Congregants, youth	Help desks after Jumu'ah, helping committees run their page	Recognition by the mosque, community-service record
Business Champion	Entrepreneurs	Onboard business associations and suppliers	Featured profile, free verification
Country Lead	Community leaders	Coordinate partnerships in one country	Paid role

Referral design. Rewards are fixed and earned, for example a free month of verification for a business that brings five verified suppliers, or priority places in scholarship webinars for students. No lucky draws or chance-based prizes (a maysir concern; confirm with the Shariah board). Rewards are paid only on verified activity, which also limits fraud.

The brief's five campaigns, mapped to the calendar

Campaign	Lead feature	Moment (approximate)	Channels	Measure
Support Muslim Businesses	Directory, B2B	Ramadan and Eid al-Fitr (Feb–Mar 2027); Dhul Hijjah (mid-May 2027)	Mosques, business associations, WhatsApp, Instagram	Verified businesses added
Discover the Muslim World	Travel content, Directory	School holidays and travel seasons	YouTube, TikTok, Instagram	Views turned into sign-ups
Connect Muslim Universities	Education Network	Scholarship and intake seasons	Campuses, LinkedIn, YouTube	Applications started
Muslim Excellence Worldwide	STEM and Medical Cities Index; alumni stories	Annual Index launch	Media, LinkedIn	Earned media mentions
One Ummah, One Marketplace	B2B sourcing	Only after the B2B beta proves out	Trade shows, chambers, LinkedIn	Requests answered

6.10 Reasons to return: the frequency ladder

The brief says it best: *downloads create visibility; regular usage creates a successful business.* Each item on the brief's list of reasons to return is mapped to a rhythm, so that at least one reason recurs every week.

Rhythm	Reason to return	Brief's list item
Daily	Personalised opportunity feed: scholarship deadlines, jobs, halal offers nearby; updates from your mosque	Opportunities, jobs, halal products

Rhythm	Reason to return	Brief's list item
Weekly	Jumu'ah digest from your mosques; newly verified businesses nearby; community initiatives	Community initiatives
Monthly	Scholarship and research digest; events; knowledge content	Scholarships, research and knowledge
Seasonal	Ramadan, Eid, Hajj and Umrah, academic intakes, travel seasons	Cultural discoveries

6.11 Trust architecture and private AI

Level	What is checked	What users see
0 Listed	Self-submitted	No badge
1 Identity verified	Phone, email and the administrator's ID	"Verified admin"
2 Institution verified	Registration documents or a registry check	"Verified institution"
3 Halal verified	Certificate number and expiry checked with the issuing authority (for example JAKIM, BPJPH, the Pakistan Halal Authority)	"Halal certificate verified, expires (date)"
4 Community endorsed	Vouched for by a verified mosque, university or association	"Endorsed by (name)"

The privacy pledge, published on day one

- We never sell personal or location data.
- We never target advertising on religious practice.
- Precise location is optional; we collect the minimum data needed.
- Data is hosted locally where the law requires it.
- An independent audit and a transparency report every year.
- A Shariah and ethics board, spanning madhahib, publishes the neutrality and moderation policy.

Private AI as an advantage. The team's private-AI skills power multilingual search and translation, matching (students to scholarships, buyers to suppliers), scam detection and moderation, all on infrastructure Ummah One controls. Personalisation therefore never requires selling data, which turns the privacy pledge from a cost into a feature.

6.12 Education Network: Muslim World STEM and Medical Cities

The brief's 18-city list becomes the backbone of the Education Network. It ranks *cities*, not countries, which is more useful to a student choosing where to live. Before publishing, the ranking needs a transparent method (QS and THE positions, research output, infrastructure) and Muslim-life factors (prayer facilities, halal food, cost of living, scholarships, housing for women). Published every year with an academic partner, the **Ummah One Muslim World STEM and Medical Cities Index** becomes an owned media asset, in the way rankings generate press for QS and THE.

#	City	Flagship institutions (from the brief)	Strengths (from the brief)	Check
1	Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia	Universiti Malaya	Medical sciences, engineering, mathematics; international branch campuses	UM 58th QS 2026 (brief says ~59th); 56th QS 2027
2	Istanbul, Türkiye	ITU, Boğaziçi, Istanbul University, Koç, Sabancı	Deep concentration of STEM and medical faculties	Not yet verified
3	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia	King Saud University, Princess Nourah University	Research funding, medical cities, advanced labs	Not yet verified

#	City	Flagship institutions (from the brief)	Strengths (from the brief)	Check
4	Dhahran / Dammam, Saudi Arabia	KFUPM	Physics, chemical engineering, applied sciences	KFUPM 67th QS 2026 (up from 101)
5	Ankara, Türkiye	METU, Bilkent	Theoretical physics, mathematics, engineering	Not yet verified
6	Doha, Qatar	Education City (Weill Cornell Medicine–Qatar, Texas A&M at Qatar), Qatar University	Accredited North American medical and engineering degrees	Not yet verified
7	Abu Dhabi, UAE	Khalifa University, NYU Abu Dhabi	Physics, computer science, materials, biomedical research	Not yet verified
8	Penang, Malaysia	Universiti Sains Malaysia	Pharmaceutical sciences, biotechnology, medical technology	Not yet verified
9	Cairo, Egypt	Cairo University, Ain Shams University	Clinical and scientific publishing volume	Not yet verified
10	Astana, Kazakhstan	Nazarbayev University, Astana Medical University	Central Asia's top STEM research university	THE 2026: 401–500 band; reported top 400 in THE 2027
11	Almaty, Kazakhstan	Al-Farabi KazNU, Kazakh National Medical University	Mathematics, natural sciences, medicine	Not yet verified
12	Dubai, UAE	MBRU, Dubai Medical College, branch campuses	Specialised medical education, digital health	Not yet verified
13	İzmir, Türkiye	İzmir Institute of Technology, Ege University	Natural sciences, biotechnology, health technology	Not yet verified
14	Amman, Jordan	University of Jordan, JUST	Medicine, nursing, pharmacology, engineering	Not yet verified
15	Baku, Azerbaijan	Baku State University, Azerbaijan Medical University	Clinical healthcare, applied mathematics, energy engineering	Not yet verified
16	Alexandria, Egypt	Alexandria University	Medicine, pharmacology, physical chemistry, marine science	Not yet verified
17	Tashkent, Uzbekistan	National University of Uzbekistan, Tashkent Pediatric Medical Institute	Theoretical physics, mathematical modelling, paediatrics	Not yet verified
18	Rabat, Morocco	Mohammed V University	Mathematical sciences, physics, medical education	Not yet verified

6.13 Discover the Muslim World: Muslim-friendly destinations

Travel content is the brief's "cultural discoveries" reason to return. It sits inside the Directory, not as a new division, and earns affiliate revenue later. The sector is real: Muslim-friendly travel is projected to grow from US$216.9 billion (2023) to US$384.1 billion (2028). In the 2025 Global Muslim Travel Index, Malaysia ranked first among OIC destinations, Singapore first among non-OIC destinations, and Thailand was in the non-OIC top five.

Destination	Brief's claim	What we found	Action
Satun, Thailand	~70% Muslim; safe; Koh Lipe; halal food	Sources range from 67.8% to 76.8% Muslim, by data year	Keep; say "about 70%"
Koh Lanta, Thailand	~60% Muslim; family beaches, night markets	Described as mostly Thai Muslim; no percentage found. Koh Lanta is in Krabi province	Drop the number until sourced
Srinagar, India	Over 95% Muslim; Dal Lake	Not verified in this pass	Verify against 2011 census
Kozhikode, India	~40% Muslim; Malabar hospitality	Not verified in this pass	Verify against 2011 census

Destination	Brief's claim	What we found	Action
Lakshadweep, India	~96% Muslim; islands and reefs	Not verified in this pass	Verify against 2011 census
Hyderabad, India	~40% Muslim	City (GHMC) about 30%; district about 43% (2011 census)	Correct: say which boundary
Lucknow, India	~40% Muslim	City about 26%; district about 21% (2011 census)	**Correct before publishing**

Sensitivity. Some destinations, Kashmir in particular, are politically sensitive. Content stays neutral and safety-aware, links to official travel advisories, and carries no political commentary.

6.14 Business model and revenue streams

Revenue stream	Who pays	Model	When
Business verification and premium profiles	Halal businesses	Annual subscription	From MVP launch
B2B sourcing	Suppliers and buyers	Per request for quotation, or a success fee	After the B2B beta
University partnerships	Universities	Featured profiles, events, lead fees where lawful	From MVP launch
Scholarship and job postings	Foundations, employers	Posting fees (free for charitable scholarships)	Phase 2
Travel	Booking partners	Affiliate commission	Phase 2
Contextual sponsorship	Halal brands	Non-personalised placements	Phase 3, within the pledge
Never	—	Selling personal data; targeting on religious data; fees on zakat or sadaqah	—

What must be true to break even (hypothetical inputs, arithmetic only)

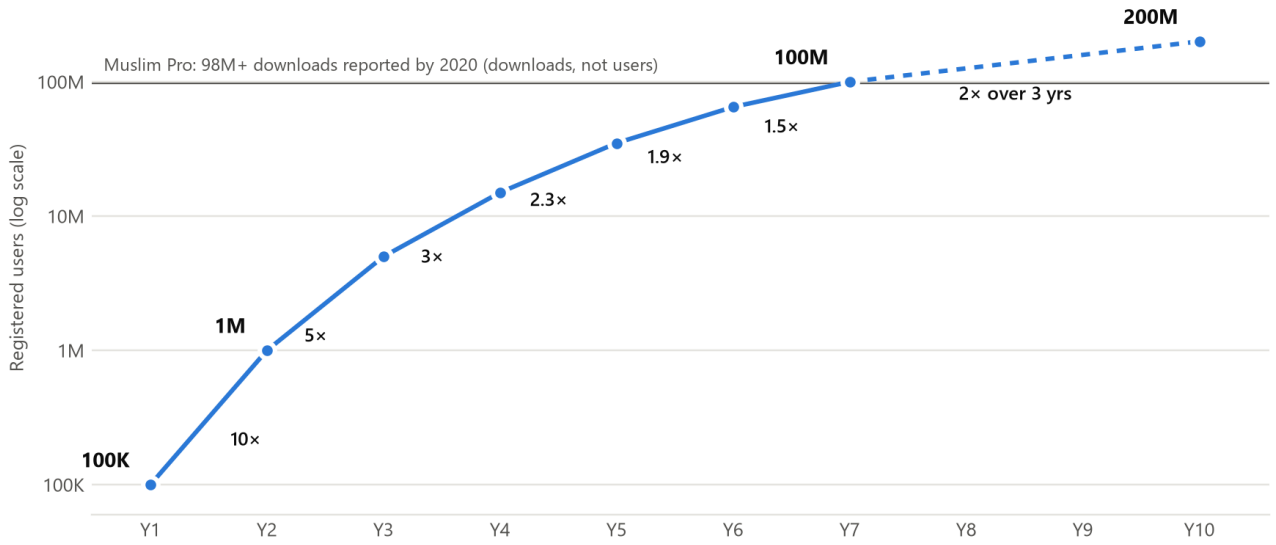
Monthly operating cost	At US$10 per paying account per month	At US$25	At US$50
US$50,000	5,000 paying accounts	2,000	1,000
US$100,000	10,000	4,000	2,000
US$250,000	25,000	10,000	5,000

The real cost base and prices are unknown and must come from the finance SME. The table shows the shape of the problem: with individuals free, Ummah One needs thousands of paying institutions, so pre-selling verification during the pilot is a gate.

6.15 The 200M maths: targets, gates and what must be true

The brief's targets need 10× growth in year 2, then 1.5–5× every year

Ummah One registered-user targets by year; multiples show the growth each step requires



Targets from the brief: Year 1 100K; Year 2 1M; Year 3 5M; Year 4 15M; Year 5 35M; Year 6 65M; Year 7 100M; Years 8–10 200M. Years 8 and 9 have no separate target. The Muslim Pro reference is downloads, not registered users, and is shown only for scale.

200 million is about 10% of the world's Muslims. Even full success in the five priority markets is unlikely to reach it alone, so wave-2 markets are needed: Bangladesh, Türkiye, Egypt, Nigeria, India, and the diaspora. North America saw the fastest percentage growth in its Muslim population between 2010 and 2020 (52%, Pew).

Stage gates (proposed thresholds, to be set with the finance SME)

Gate	Proposed pass criteria	Decision it unlocks
G0: end of March 2027, after the Ramadan pilot	At least 50 mosques live; at least 20% of pilot users still active four weeks after Eid; at least 30 businesses pre-pay for verification; at least 5 university letters of intent	Build the full MVP
G1: 100,000 registered	At least 30% of registered users active monthly; at least half of sign-ups from mosques, campuses or referrals; verification cost per listing within budget	Open the second country
G2: 1 million	Paying institutions cover a set share of operating cost; 30-day retention stable across monthly cohorts	Raise a growth round; all five markets
G3: 10 million+	Share of members connected to two or more institutions is rising (network effects)	Wave-2 markets

6.16 12-month roadmap (November 2026 to October 2027)

When	Phase	Key outputs
Nov–Dec 2026	Validate	150 user interviews (30 per market), 20 mosque committees, 10 universities, 30 halal SMEs; pick the pilot city; form the Shariah and ethics board (3–5 scholars); trademark check; privacy pledge v1; landing pages in five languages to test which feature people sign up for
Jan 2027	Build the pilot	Ramadan Companion web app: mosque pages, taraweeh, iftar and i'tikaf schedules, Eid prayer finder; sign 10–15 lighthouse mosques and 30–45 twin mosques; recruit 50 ambassadors
Feb–Mar 2027	Ramadan pilot	Ramadan expected about 8 February to 9 March 2027; help desks after Jumu'ah; measure everything
End Mar 2027	Gate G0	Go or no-go on the full MVP

When	Phase	Key outputs
Apr–Jul 2027	Build the MVP	Directory and Education Network; first version of the STEM and Medical Cities guide; verification operations; five languages
Mid-May 2027	Dhul Hijjah	Eid al-Adha (approximate date): Qurbani and Eid prayer information; Hajj content
Aug–Sep 2027	Launch two cities	500 mosques, 50 universities, 1,000 verified businesses; first ambassador cohort (200)
Oct 2027	Scale to 100,000	Plan the B2B sourcing beta; publish the Index for scholarship season
Next	Ramadan 2028	Late January 2028 (approximate): national push toward 1 million

The brief's partnership targets stand: 50 universities, 100 business organisations, 100 community partners. This plan adds 500 partner mosques by month 12.

6.17 Key metrics and milestones

North Star metric: Weekly Active Connected Members, the number of members active in a week who interact with at least one verified institution. It rewards exactly what the strategy needs: frequency, trust and network depth. Registered users and downloads are tracked, but never steer the company.

Category	Metrics
Growth	Registered users; monthly active users; share of active to registered; sign-ups by channel (mosque, campus, referral, paid)
Engagement	7-day and 30-day retention by cohort and by channel; weekly sessions per member
Network	Active mosques (updated weekly); verified businesses; universities; members connected to two or more institutions
Monetisation	Paying institutions; revenue per paying account; requests for quotation answered; applications started
Trust	Share of listings verified; fraud reports per 10,000 listings; time to resolve; trust score in surveys

6.18 Team, technology and operations

Area	Requirements
Core team	CEO and partnerships; CTO; Head of Community and Mosque Partnerships; Head of Trust and Verification; product and design lead; education partnerships lead; country leads (Pakistan, Malaysia, Indonesia first); data protection officer (part-time at first)
Governance	Shariah and ethics advisory board of 3–5 scholars across madhahib; published neutrality and moderation policy
Technology	Android-first app plus a lightweight web version for low-end phones; WhatsApp integration (share links, notifications, admin bot); five languages at launch; private-AI search, matching and scam detection; verification workflow tools; local hosting options; security threat model
Operations	Country teams on one shared platform; verification analysts; community managers; moderation in five languages; partner success for mosques and universities

6.19 Funding requirement and use of funds

The amount cannot be stated honestly yet: team size, location and salaries are unknown. Funding should be released in phases. Phase 0 (validation and Ramadan pilot, about 3 months) is founder or angel funded. Phase 1 (MVP to 100,000 users, about 9 months) is a seed round sized by a cost model built in Phase 0. Phase 2 (to 1 million) is raised only after Gate G1.

Use of Phase 1 funds (proposed allocation)	Share	Why
Product and engineering	40%	MVP, five languages, private-AI features, security

Use of Phase 1 funds (proposed allocation)	Share	Why
Community and partnerships	25%	Mosques, campuses, ambassadors, Opportunity Days
Trust, verification and safety	15%	Verification analysts, scam detection, moderation
Brand, content and campaigns	12%	Deliberately below community spend: growth is designed to be community-driven
Legal, compliance and governance	8%	Counsel in each country, data protection, Shariah board

6.20 Major risks and mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early warning
Low frequency, empty network	High	High	Mosque layer as weekly anchor; frequency ladder; launch city by city	30-day retention below gate
Trust breach (data, fake halal, scams)	Medium	Very high	Verification tiers; privacy pledge; audit; scam detection	Rising fraud reports
Religious or political controversy	Medium	High	Neutrality policy; Shariah board; no political content in MVP	Moderation escalations
Regulatory block or delay	Medium	High	Counsel per country; local hosting; authority-level partnerships	Approval timelines slipping
Cash runs out before revenue	Medium	High	Pre-sell verification in the pilot; phased funding; lean team	Months of runway below 9
Competitors add halal filters	Medium	Medium	Moat is the verified institutional graph and mosque relationships	Feature launches by big platforms
Dilution across markets and features	High	High	Corridor sequencing; explicit "out" list	Roadmap growing faster than the team
Security incident	Medium	Very high	Threat model; minimal data; encryption; bug bounty	Attack attempts

Likelihood and impact are analyst judgments to be reviewed with the risk SME.

7. Decision memo

A. Executive summary

Ummah One should be built as the verified infrastructure of the Muslim economy and community, grown through mosques, campuses and business associations rather than advertising. The brief's vision is sound; its entry is too broad. Narrow the entry to a mosque-anchored Directory plus the Education Network in one city, prove weekly use and willingness to pay through a Ramadan 2027 pilot in lighthouse mosques, then expand corridor by corridor.

B. Recommended decision

> **GO, conditional: pivot the entry, keep the vision**
>
> Proceed to a 90-day validation phase ending with the Ramadan 2027 pilot. Commit to the full MVP only if Gate G0 passes at the end of March 2027. Do not launch in five countries at once, and do not build consumer e-commerce.

C. Confidence level

Medium overall: Medium for 100,000 to 1 million users if the mosque and campus channels validate; Low for 200 million within 10 years.

D. Rationale

- The only channel whose scale matches the ambition is the mosque network, and it carries built-in trust and a weekly rhythm.
- The three core features are occasional jobs; the mosque layer supplies the frequency they lack.
- Students and halal exporters feel the sharpest pain; businesses and universities can pay, so the free consumer side can be funded.
- Trust is the scarce asset in this category; a verified, private, neutral platform is hard to copy.
- Ramadan 2027 offers a cheap, time-boxed test of the riskiest assumptions within 13 weeks.

E. Critical assumptions

A1 to A10 in Section 2. The four that decide the outcome: **A2** (mosques adopt and promote), **A4** (businesses pay), **A6** (neutral governance holds) and **A9** (community channels are cheaper than paid ads).

F. Evidence needed before final commitment

- 150 user interviews across the five markets, with findings on the most urgent job for each group.
- Signed participation from at least 50 mosques for the pilot, including lighthouse and twin mosques.
- At least 5 university letters of intent; at least 30 businesses pre-paying for verification.
- Ramadan pilot data: members per mosque, retention four weeks after Eid, cost per member by channel.
- Written opinions from the Shariah board (mosque promotion, referral rewards, sponsorship) and from counsel in the pilot country.
- Trademark clearance for "Ummah One"; a measured verification cost per listing.

G. Top 5 risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
1. Low frequency leads to an empty network	Mosque layer, weekly digest, launch one city at a time
2. Trust breach	Verification tiers, privacy pledge, annual audit, scam detection
3. Religious or political controversy	Neutrality policy, cross-madhhab Shariah board, no political content
4. Regulation (data, religious content, influencers)	Counsel per country, local hosting, partnerships at authority level
5. Cash runs out before revenue	Pre-sell verification, phased funding, lean team

H. First 30, 60 and 90 days

By	Actions
Day 30 (5 Dec 2026)	Name the core team and the Shariah and ethics board; trademark check; 60 user interviews, 15 mosque committees, 5 universities; pick the pilot city; design the Ramadan pilot; publish the privacy pledge draft; launch feature landing pages in five languages
Day 60 (4 Jan 2027)	Sign 10–15 lighthouse mosques and 30–45 twin mosques; build the Ramadan Companion web app; recruit 50 ambassadors; draft the STEM and Medical Cities Index method with an academic partner; data-protection opinion in the pilot country
Day 90 (3 Feb 2027)	Pilot ready before Ramadan begins (about 8 Feb); help desks staffed for every Jumu'ah; dashboards live; 10 university conversations, 5 letters of intent; pre-sell verification to halal businesses

I. Questions for subject-matter experts

Expert	Questions
Islamic scholars	How should Ummah One be presented in mosques within adab? Which referral rewards are permissible? May halal businesses sponsor mosque tools? How should a cross-madhhab board decide disputes?
Mosque administrators	Who decides on new tools, and how fast? What are typical Jumu'ah and Ramadan attendances? What would save the committee the most time?
University international offices	Which recruitment fees are lawful and acceptable? What data do they need on applicants? Which scholarship cycles matter most?
Halal certification bodies	Can certificates be checked through a public registry or API? Would they partner on verification?
Lawyers (each country)	Data residency; religious-content approvals; influencer permits; education-agent rules; platform liability; trademark
Finance	Realistic prices per market; cost model for Phase 0 and 1; gate thresholds
Growth and community	Ambassador economics; cost per member by channel; creator licensing
Security	Threat model for a high-profile Muslim platform; protection of minority users' data

8. Expert confirmation

Two independent reviewers examined the proposed decision: one to challenge it, one to test whether it can be built and run.

Reviewer 1: Challenger (red team) — argues against the recommendation

Position	Pivot further: launch the **Education Network alone**. It has the clearest pain, a clear buyer (universities) and a natural ambassador base (students). The Directory and Marketplace dilute focus.
Objection to mosques	Mosque partnerships are slow (committee decisions; ministry approvals in the Gulf) and may brand Ummah One as a religious app, which would put off businesses and universities.
Objection to lighthouse mosques	Starting in high-income areas risks an elite image that is hard to undo.
What would change their mind	Pilot evidence that mosque-acquired members stay as long as campus-acquired members and cost less to acquire.

Reviewer 2: Feasibility — tests whether the plan can be built and run

Pilot	Feasible in about 10–12 weeks only if scope stays at mosque pages, Ramadan schedules and sign-up. Anything more misses Ramadan.
MVP	Feasible in about four months for a small team if the Marketplace and payments are excluded. The bottlenecks are verification operations, multilingual content and partnership sales, not engineering.
Gulf partnerships	Likely to take many months; keep them off year one's critical path while starting conversations early (analyst estimate).
Verdict	Feasible as scoped, with the timeline risk concentrated in the January 2027 pilot build.

Where the reviewers disagree with the recommendation, and the evidence that settles it

Topic	Recommendation	Challenger	Evidence that resolves it
Scope at launch	Education plus a mosque-anchored Directory; B2B later	Education only	Landing-page sign-up rates by feature; pilot retention by feature used
Mosque channel	Primary growth engine	Too slow and too religious in image	Members per mosque and cost per member in the pilot, against the campus channel
Lighthouse mosques	Start in high-income areas, twin downwards	Elite image risk	Adoption in twin mosques; perception interviews in both
Gulf in year one	Corridor destination; talks start early	Defer entirely	Response times from authorities to partnership proposals

Status of this recommendation

PROPOSED — requires confirmation by qualified human subject-matter experts. It must not be treated as approved until the relevant human experts confirm the market, financial, legal, operational, Shariah and product assumptions.

9. Working Backwards PRFAQ (BMAD)

BMAD's PRFAQ method writes the launch press release before building, then attacks it with the hardest customer and internal questions. Everything below is *imagined*, to test the concept; names in quotes are illustrative personas, not real people.

Imagined press release · Karachi and Kuala Lumpur, 1 September 2027

Ummah One opens in Karachi and Kuala Lumpur: find your masjid, your scholarship and a trusted halal supplier in one verified place

Students, families and halal businesses can now find verified mosques, universities, scholarships and certified suppliers in Urdu, Malay, Bahasa Indonesia, Arabic and English, starting with 500 partner mosques and 50 universities.

Until today, a student in Karachi looking for a scholarship in Kuala Lumpur relied on agents, forwarded messages and luck. A halal food maker could not prove its certificate to a buyer in Dubai without weeks of emails. Ummah One verifies institutions and halal certificates at the source and never sells its members' data.

"The Ummah has always been connected through its masajid. We are building the digital version of that trust." — Founder, Ummah One (illustrative)

"I found my scholarship through my mosque's page and checked the university was real in one minute." — Ayesha, pharmacy student, Karachi (illustrative persona)

Customer FAQ (hardest first)

Question	Answer
After Muslim Pro, why should I trust you with my data?	We publish a pledge never to sell personal or location data, keep precise location optional, host data locally where required, and publish an independent audit every year.
Which madhhab or group do you follow?	None. A cross-madhhab board sets a neutrality policy; Ummah One verifies facts, not beliefs.
Is the halal certificate real?	Level-3 profiles show the certificate number and expiry, checked with the issuing authority.

Question	Answer
Why not just use Google Maps and WhatsApp?	Keep using WhatsApp: Ummah One shares into your groups. It adds what they cannot: verification, search and a memory of opportunities.
Is it free?	Yes, for individuals, for ever. Businesses and universities pay for premium tools.

Internal FAQ (hardest first)

Question	Answer
What kills this?	Low frequency. If nothing brings members back weekly, the network empties. That is why the mosque layer comes first.
Why us?	A private-AI team can offer personalisation without selling data, which turns the trust pledge into a product advantage. Our relationships with mosques and campuses are still to be proven.
How do we get the first 100 mosques?	Lighthouse mosques in one city, twinned with sister mosques, with ambassadors doing setup and Jumu'ah help desks.
What do we say no to?	Consumer e-commerce, payments, zakat collection, social feed and chat, political content, and a five-country launch.
What are the unit economics?	Unknown today. Section 6.14 shows what must be true; the pilot pre-sells verification to find out.

The verdict

Rating	Findings
Forged in steel	Positioning as infrastructure, not an app; mosques as the atomic network; trust and privacy as the moat; Education as the sharpest entry
Needs more heat	Pricing and unit economics; Marketplace scope; choice of first city; ambassador economics; publishing method for the Cities Index
Cracks in the foundation	The 200M target against a low-frequency product; neutrality governance across sects and governments; data residency in five jurisdictions; a team stretched across five markets

Appendix A. Assumptions register

ID	Assumption	Test	Owner	By
A1	One cross-border platform is wanted	Interviews; landing-page sign-ups by country	Product	Dec 2026
A2	Mosques adopt and promote	Pilot sign-ups and weekly page updates	Community	Mar 2027
A3	Students switch from agents and portals	Applications started in the pilot city	Education	Oct 2027
A4	Businesses pay for verification	Pre-sales during the pilot	Partnerships	Mar 2027
A5	Universities pay, lawfully	Letters of intent; legal opinion	Education, Legal	Mar 2027
A6	Neutral governance holds	Board formed; moderation incidents tracked	Governance	Ongoing
A7	Authority partnerships possible	Proposals sent; response times	CEO	Jun 2027
A8	Verification cost is acceptable	Measured cost per listing	Trust	Jul 2027
A9	Community channels are cheaper	Cost per member by channel	Growth	Mar 2027
A10	Five languages at launch	Content and moderation capacity test	Operations	Jul 2027

Appendix B. Sources (checked 5 November 2026)

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BMAD Method, official repository	https://github.com/bmad-code-org/BMAD-METHOD
Concepts: Andrew Chen, The Cold Start Problem (2021); Chris Dixon, "Come for the tool, stay for the network" (2015)	Concept reference

Legal references (data protection and halal laws) and the names of religious authorities come from general knowledge and must be confirmed by counsel and local partners. Entries marked "To confirm" or "Not yet verified" in the tables were not checked in this research pass.